

Constitution of The Bell Tower Boys

Article I: Name

Section 1: The name of this organization shall be The Bell Tower Boys.

Article II: Purpose

Section 1: The Bell Tower Boys is an all male a cappella ensemble at Furman University. The group is an opportunity for advanced singers to learn and practice the musical style of A Cappella singing, as well as to be a source of entertainment for all in the Furman community. Each semester the ensemble puts on a concert for the entertainment of the student body. In addition to these concerts, The Bell Tower Boys serve as entertainment at a variety of Furman events, to include singing for various non-profit organizations, official Furman administration meetings, and any other event that would benefit Furman both on and off campus. The Bell Tower Boys exists just as much for the entertainment of the students, faculty, and alumni of Furman University as it does for singers in the ensemble.

Article III: Membership

- Section 1:** The membership of this organization shall consist of enrolled male Furman University students (members will be hereby called boys).
- Section 2:** This organization and its boys shall not discriminate against any individuals for reasons of race, national origin, color, religion, age, veteran status, sexual orientation, and/or ability status.
- Section 3:** Membership of this organization shall be granted to students who successfully navigate the audition process and are deemed fit by the current boys of the group.
- A. Membership shall be maintained throughout the entirety of a boys time at Furman, excepting violations of group policy.

Article IV: Officers

- Section 1:** All officers are expected to be at practice and performances and allowed to speak at any performance. As well as these general expectations, each officer has his own basic duties outlined below:
- A. President - The President shall be the parliamentarian of the group; conducting voting at the officer and general meetings, addressing general issues and administrative needs, and presiding over meetings to aid in their fluency and promote collaboration.

- B.* Music Director - The Music Director shall be in charge of directing the group and leading rehearsals, approving new music for performances, and bettering the musical value of the whole group.
- C.* Secretary - The Secretary shall be in charge of finding and coordinating gigs, taking attendance at practice, scheduling practices and performances, and making sure that events are well advertised.
- D.* Treasurer - The Treasurer shall manage our budget both from SGA and our own bank account.

Section 2: To qualify for an officer position the candidate must have been in the group for one academic year and must demonstrate a genuine commitment to the betterment of the group.

Section 3: One term of office shall be one academic year per term.

Section 4: An officer may hold his office for the entirety of his time at Furman, but must be re-elected each year to do so.

Section 5: Should an office become vacant the group will collectively vote on a replacement.

Article V: Meetings

Section 1: Regularly scheduled meetings of the organization (hereby known as practice) shall be varied such that they will best accommodate the schedules of the boys.

Section 2: Extra meetings of the organization shall be limited to administrative affairs, extra practices, and performances:

- A.* Business meetings of the organization shall be held to discuss budget, schedule, and and issues that may arise within the group.
- B.* Extra practices of the organization shall be held in the event that the majority of the group feels that more rehearsal time is needed.
- C.* Performances of the organization shall be held with sufficient prior notice and most of the group present.

Section 3: Officer meetings of the organization shall be at least once a month and can additionally be scheduled at the leisure of the officers. These meetings will discuss at least the schedule, gigs, and the current state of the group (financially and functionally).

Article VI: Amendments

Section 1: This constitution shall be amended by $\frac{3}{4}$'s majority of the group.

Section 2: Provision for advance notice shall be two consecutive business meetings with discussion of the amendment before putting it to a vote.

By-Laws of the Belltower Boys

Article I: Membership

- Section 1:** For the boys to decide that a prospect has navigated the audition process successfully he must demonstrate some musical prowess including at least the ability to sing, tune, blend, and perform. In addition to these basic skills, the boys will evaluate each audition for a number of other factors which may increase the cohesion of the group.
- Section 2:** The requirements for continued membership shall be active participation, constant cooperation with the group, and representing the group well outside of the context of formal Bell Tower Boys events.
- Section 3:** There shall be at least 10 boys in this organization.
- Section 4:** In the event that our bank account needs a buffer, the group may require the boys of this organization to pay up to 20 dollars for emergency situations.

Article II: Officers

- Section 1:** Candidates will nominate themselves.
- Section 2:** The selection of officers shall be conducted at the end of each year before the spring concert and a simple majority (plurality) will decide the top two. If one individual gets over $\frac{1}{2}$ of the votes in the first round, a runoff is not necessary. In the event that the total number of boys in the group is an even number, the standing officer for the position currently being voted on shall abstain.
- Section 3:** No boy shall hold multiple offices during one term.
- Section 4:** The first (recorded) officers of this organization for the 2014-2015 academic year are:
- A. President - Kolby Merryman
 - B. Music Director - Drew Whitlow
 - C. Secretary - Mark Lukridge
 - D. Treasurer - Will Lear

Article III: Meetings

- Section 1:** Practices shall be scheduled at least one full week in advance. The Secretary will collect all of the boys' schedules at the beginning of the semester to decide on a regular practice time. In the event that this regular time needs to be changed, the Secretary must notify all of the

boys. Reasons for changing the regular practice time include: less than $\frac{3}{4}$'s of the group being available for academic or other excused absences and conflicts with meeting such as lack of space or weather.

Section 2: Business meetings may be at the end of regular practice time if the group is given a week's notice. Otherwise, business meetings are the responsibility of the President to schedule with the Secretary as needed. These meetings shall be governed generally by "Robert's Rules of Order".

Section 3: Extra practices shall be brought up during business meetings, will need a majority of the group with at least $\frac{2}{3}$'s of the group present to pass, and will be in addition the regular practice time for the scheduled week.

Section 4: Formal performances shall require 2 weeks prior notice for members and at least $\frac{3}{4}$ of the group being present. The Secretary is in charge of organizing these. Boys are expected to be present at all performances unless for an excusable reason.

Section 5: Informal performances must include at least half of the membership or sufficient people on each part. These performances may be at any time with any amount of prior notice.

Article IV: Group Policies

Section 1: Practice and Performance etiquette shall be under the discretion of the music director as well as the following:

- A. Be on time
- B. Be prepared
- C. No intoxication

Section 2: Formal attire is as follows:

- i. White dress shirt (button down)
- ii. Khaki dress pants
- iii. Blue blazer
- iv. Neck tie
- v. Brown belt
- vi. Brown shoes

Exceptions will be made for gigs if the group collectively ($\frac{3}{4}$) decides it would be more appropriate; i.e. themed events.

Section 3: "Ramig's Rule" states that if a boy is not participating in practices and performances, then the group has the ability to revoke his membership with $\frac{3}{4}$'s vote. The boys may bring up issues with other members to the executive officers, and in the event that 3 or more individuals comment on another boys participation, the boy in question will have his membership discussed at a business meeting. Otherwise, the executive

officers may decide to discussed a boys membership at a business meeting. The boy in question must be given fair warning of both the impending punishment that may come from a lack of participation (before needing a meeting) as well as the meeting itself.

Section 4: Excused absences will be granted by the President with his best judgement. Excused absences include academic commitments, personal issues, and commitments to other groups that were scheduled before said Bell Tower Boys event. These and any other issues that arise must be approved by the President with at least 2 weeks prior notice.

Article V: Amendments

Section 1: These By-Laws shall be amended by $\frac{3}{4}$'s majority of the group.

Section 2: Provision for advance notice shall be two consecutive business meetings with discussion of the amendment before putting it to a vote.

Notes:

Written by Samuel Hill with edits by Pearson Fowler and the three group meetings in which this document was discussed.
Ratified by the group on January 20th, 2015.